

COLLECTIVE LOFT

Morgan Collective Group LLC

USER GUIDE

Getting Started on Collective Loft

Everything you need to find your collaborator and make something real.

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OVERVIEW

Welcome to Collective Loft.

Collective Loft is a professional network built for creatives who are serious about collaboration — artists, musicians, writers, designers, filmmakers, and makers. Not a marketplace. Not a portfolio dump. A living network of people making real things together.

This guide walks you through every step of the platform, from creating your account to closing your first completed collaboration.

THE 6 STEPS OF A COLLECTIVE LOFT COLLABORATION

ST EP	WHAT HAPPENS
1	Create your account — enter your name, email, and password
2	Subscribe — 7-day free trial, then \$15/month. No access without an active subscription.
3	Complete your profile — disciplines, skills, bio, headline, and collaboration preferences
4	Discover or post a brief — find the right collaborator or let them find you
5	Set Collab Terms — agree on the project, deliverables, timeline, and compensation before work begins
6	Work in the Loft Studio — a shared workspace that opens automatically once terms are accepted

STEP 1

Create Your Account

IMPORTANT

Access to Collective Loft requires an active subscription. The sign-up flow takes you directly from account creation to payment before you can access the platform.

1.1 The Sign-Up Flow

Collective Loft uses a three-step onboarding flow designed to get you from zero to active member as cleanly as possible.

- 1 Go to the platform and click **Join** or **Build Your Profile**.
- 2 On the **Sign Up** page: enter your first name, last name, email, and a password (minimum 8 characters). Click **Continue to Membership**.
- 3 On the **Subscribe** page: review the \$15/month plan with 7-day free trial. Click **Start Free Trial**.
- 4 You are redirected to **Stripe's secure checkout**. Enter your payment details and click Start trial. Your card is not charged until the 7-day trial ends.
- 5 After payment, you are redirected to the **Profile Completion form**. Your name and email are pre-filled. Fill in your disciplines, skills, bio, and accept the Terms & Conditions and Privacy Policy.
- 6 Click **Complete my profile**. You land on your completed profile with full platform access.

TIP

Your subscription begins with a 7-day free trial. You will not be charged until the trial ends. Cancel anytime from your profile page.

1.2 Required Profile Fields

The Complete my profile button remains disabled until every required field is filled and both legal documents are accepted.

Field	What to Enter
First name & Last name	Your real name — entered during sign-up, pre-filled on the form
Email	Pre-populated from sign-up — read only
Discipline	At least one discipline selected from the grid (8 options)
Skills	At least one specific skill selected from your discipline's list

Field	What to Enter
Headline	One line describing what you do — write it like you'd say it to another creative
Bio	A short description of your creative practice
Terms & Conditions	Must read (scroll to bottom to unlock) and accept
Privacy Policy	Must read (scroll to bottom to unlock) and accept

1.3 Signing In

Once your profile is complete, sign in any time at the platform URL. Click **Sign in**, enter your email and password, and you are taken directly to your profile.

If you forget your password, click **Forgot your password** on the sign-in page. Enter your email and we will send a reset link.

STEP 2

Your Subscription

2.1 Pricing

Plan	Price	Trial	Access
Collective Loft Membership	\$15.00 USD/month	7 days free	Full platform access

2.2 What's Included

Your \$15/month gets you everything — no tiers, no upsells, no locked features.

 Discover Browse all creatives, filter by discipline	 Matching Algorithm surfaces your ideal collaborators	 Collab Briefs Post projects and apply to others
 Portfolio Images, video, audio, and PDF uploads	 Loft Studio Shared workspace for active collabs	 Community Voice Ratings and reviews from collaborators

2.3 Managing Your Subscription

From your profile page, click **Manage subscription** in the navigation bar. This opens the Stripe Billing Portal where you can:

- View your current subscription status and next billing date
- Update your payment method or card details
- Download past invoices
- Cancel your subscription

CANCELLATION

If you cancel, your access continues through the end of your current paid billing period. You are not cut off immediately.

STEP 3

Complete Your Profile

3.1 The Fields That Matter Most

After paying, you land directly on the profile completion form. The fields below are what the matching algorithm uses to find you the right collaborators — fill them in carefully.

- **Disciplines** — select all that apply. This is the foundation of how the platform finds you.
- **Skills** — the specific things you do within your discipline (e.g. Film Scoring, Oil on canvas, Copywriting).
- **Skill proficiency ratings** — rate each skill 1-5. See Section 3.2 below.
- **Headline** — one line that describes what you do. Write it like you'd say it to another creative.
- **Right Now** — the most important field on your profile. What are you actively making right now? Update this regularly.
- **Collaboration preferences** — which disciplines and skills are you looking to work with? This powers Matching.

3.2 Skill Proficiency Ratings

Every skill on your profile has a five-bar proficiency rating. They tell collaborators exactly where you stand.

Rating	Label	What It Means
1 bar	Beginner	Foundational knowledge, actively developing
2 bars	Developing	Can deliver with some guidance or iteration
3 bars	Proficient	Deliver this skill reliably at a professional level
4 bars	Advanced	Deep expertise, consistently strong
5 bars	Expert	Top of this skill — sought out specifically for it

3.3 Editing Your Profile Anytime

After initial setup, click **Edit Profile** in the navigation bar at any time. Fields **auto-save on blur** — there is no save button. Your cover image and avatar can be changed by clicking on them directly while in edit mode.

TIP

Your Right Now field is the most-read part of your profile. Update it whenever your current project changes. Stale Right Now cards reduce your matches.

STEP 4

Discover & Collab Briefs

4.1 Discover

Browse all creatives on the platform. Filter by discipline using the left sidebar — 8 categories with live counts. Sort by **Recently Active**, **Most Collabs**, or **Newest Members**. Click any profile card to view their full profile.

4.2 Matching

The Matching page surfaces creatives whose seeking preferences align with your disciplines and skills. The algorithm cross-references what you offer with what others are looking for — and vice versa.

HOW MATCHING WORKS

Matching is based on your Collaboration Preferences in your profile — which disciplines and skills you're looking for — cross-referenced against other members' disciplines and skills. The more complete these fields are, the better your matches.

4.3 Collab Briefs

Briefs are project posts. Any member can post a brief or apply to one.

- **To post:** go to Collabs in the nav, click Post a Brief, fill in the project details.
- **To apply:** browse briefs, open one that interests you, click Apply.
- **To manage:** your active briefs, negotiations, and applications appear on your profile under the Briefs tab.

TIP

Applications are visible to the brief poster. They will reach out if they want to move forward. You will see a notification when they do.

STEP 5

Collab Terms

5.1 What Are Collab Terms?

Collab Terms are the agreement that opens a Loft Studio. Before any work begins, both parties define the project in writing — deliverables, timeline, compensation type, and rights arrangement. One person proposes the terms, the other reviews and either accepts or negotiates until both agree.

Once both parties accept, the Loft Studio opens automatically. Nothing starts until the terms are locked.

5.2 Compensation Types

Type	What It Means
Creative Exchange	Skills traded between parties. No money changes hands.
Paid	Fee agreed upfront between the two parties directly.
Revenue Share	Parties split revenue generated by the completed work.

LEGAL NOTE

Collective Loft is not a party to any agreement between users. All financial arrangements are between collaborators directly. For high-value or complex agreements, seek independent legal counsel.

STEP 6

The Loft Studio

6.1 How a Studio Opens

A Loft Studio opens automatically once both collaborators have accepted the Collab Terms. There is nothing to set up — the Studio is ready to use the moment terms are locked.

6.2 What's Inside the Studio

OVERVIEW Project title, collaborators, studio status, and key details at a glance	MILESTONES Shared task table with inline editing, reordering, and completion tracking
TIMELINE Visual timeline of your milestones and project phases	TERMS Locked copy of your agreed Collab Terms — read only after acceptance
FILES Shared file uploads — images, video, audio, and PDF. Both parties can upload and view.	NOTES Shared freeform notes — realtime sync. Both parties see changes as they happen.

6.3 Chat

Every Studio has a realtime chat panel. Messages appear instantly for both collaborators. Chat history is preserved for the life of the Studio.

6.4 Completing a Collaboration

When the work is done, the Studio can be closed and marked complete. Both parties are then prompted to leave a **Community Voice** rating and review. Completed Studios appear on both profiles under the Collabs tab and count toward your collaboration history.

REFERENCE

Community Voice

After a collaboration completes, both parties are prompted to rate each other. Ratings are 1-5 stars and include an optional written review and skill endorsements.

Ratings appear on your profile under the Community Voice tab. Your aggregate star rating shows in the sidebar of your profile and on your Discover card — it's how the community knows you deliver.

- Ratings must be honest and based on direct collaboration experience
- Manipulation of the rating system violates the Terms & Conditions
- Collective Loft may remove reviews that are fraudulent, abusive, or defamatory

SUPPORT

Getting Help

If you run into anything not covered in this guide:

- Email: help@collectiveloft.com
- Website: collectiveloft.com